

MORPHOLOGY & SPELLING

Middle School | Unit 13

Prefix per-



Today I am learning that the prefix per- can carry the idea through, throughout or completely.

1 Learn the Meaning

The Latin prefix per- can carry the idea through, throughout or completely. In many words the root is bound, so use the prefix clue, related words and context together.

permeate
pass or spread through

pervade
spread throughout

perforate
make holes through

persist
continue through difficulty

2 Build the Word

Use the root or related-word clue and add the morpheme shown. Build the related word, then write a short meaning clue.

Base / root	Add	New word	Meaning clue
meate (pass)	per-		
forate (pierce)	per-		
permeate	-ion		
pervade	-ive		
persist	-ent		

3 Read and Notice

Read the passage below.

During a materials investigation, our class compared how water moved through different surfaces. One tray held a perforated sheet with tiny holes. Water passed through each perforation, while a dense plastic sheet stopped it. In a sponge, moisture began to permeate the material until dampness spread throughout it.

Later, a strong vinegar smell began to pervade the room, becoming noticeable at every table. Even after the containers were sealed, the smell was persistent and seemed to persist for several minutes. The class compared these words and noticed a shared idea: something can move through a material, spread throughout a place, or continue through time or difficulty.



Highlight the per- words. Underline a related root or word-family clue when you can, then decide how the whole word connects with through or throughout.

4 Word Detective

Choose one per- word from the passage and investigate its structure, related words and meaning.

- Write a per- word from the passage.

- What base, root or related word can you identify?

- How does the word connect with through or throughout?

- Explain how the word parts help you understand it.

5 Sort the Words

Sort the words by the meaning clue.

permeate permeation perforate perforation

pervade pervasive persist persistent

Through / throughout

Continue / remain

6 Use It in Writing



Complete the sentence starters.

- A perforated material is one that _____

- Use permeate, pervade or persist in a sentence that shows its meaning.



Parent check

Tick the skills your learner has demonstrated.

- ☐ Recognises the per- meaning clue
- ☐ Connects a bound root or related word to meaning
- ☐ Distinguishes through from continue meanings
- ☐ Reads and uses target words in context



Capture idea:

Find a per- word in a science or information text. Record the word, a related word or root clue, and explain what it means in context.